



PRONOUNS

The words that stand in for a noun

1 What is it?

Pronouns (PRO-nounz)

A pronoun is a word used in place of a noun, so we don't have to keep repeating the same name or thing over and over again.

replaces + a noun already mentioned

2 See it in action

Personal

"Sarah said **she** would call **him** later."

Possessive

"That book is **mine**, not **yours**."

Relative

"The man **who** called earlier left a message."

Demonstrative

"**This** is better than **that**."



Quick reminder!

Read a paragraph and count how many times a pronoun replaces a noun instead of repeating it — usually more than you'd think.

3 More to know

Reflexive

"She made it **herself**; they did it **themselves**."

Indefinite

"**Someone** left this here — has **anyone** seen them?"

FUN FACT

"They" has been used as a singular, gender-neutral pronoun in English for over 600 years — it appears this way in the works of Chaucer and Shakespeare, long before recent debates about it.

4 Why it's used

Pronouns help: make writing flow much better — without them we'd have to keep repeating full names and nouns in every single sentence.

Common types include personal (I, you, he, she, it, we, they), possessive (mine, yours, his), and relative (who, which, that).



Keep going!

If you're not sure who 'she', 'he' or 'they' refers to when reading your own writing back, your reader won't be either — go back and clarify.

5 Don't mix it up

PRONOUNS

A pronoun replaces a specific noun already named ("Sarah" becomes "she").

A DETERMINER

A determiner comes before a noun to clarify it ("the", "this", "some") — it doesn't replace the noun, it introduces it.

⚠ Watch out!

A pronoun needs a clear "antecedent" (the noun it's replacing) — if it's unclear who "she" or "they" refers to, the sentence becomes confusing.

6 Quick recap

Replaces a noun

Avoids repetition

Needs a clear reference



You got this!

Try replacing every pronoun in a short paragraph with the full noun again — notice how repetitive and clunky it sounds.